

PadCaster Video Kit

WHAT'S IN THE KIT

- PadCaster frame and accessories for professional iPad video recording



QUICK-START GUIDE

1. Mount the iPad in the PadCaster frame.
2. Attach mic and lens; mount on a tripod for stable shots.
3. Frame using rule of thirds; check audio with headphones.
4. Shoot, then edit in WeVideo or iMovie.

FULL LESSONS IN THIS GUIDE

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PRO TIP: Stable mount + external mic solves the two things that make student video look amateur.

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LESSON · GRADES 3-5

School News Desk

LEARNING OUTCOMES

- Students will operate studio equipment in production roles
- Students will read broadcast copy with fluency and expression
- Students will produce a recurring news segment

MATERIALS

- PadCaster rig + tripod + mic + iPad
- Anchor desk setup and backdrop
- Script template: greeting, 3 stories, sign-off
- Cue cards or teleprompter app

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Study 60 seconds of real news delivery: posture, pace, handoffs.
2. Crews of 4: two anchors, camera operator, director.
3. Write the episode from school happenings using the script template.
4. Rehearse twice: once for words, once for camera presence.
5. Roll the real take — small stumbles stay, that's broadcasting.
6. Screen for the class; rotate crews weekly so everyone anchors.

ACTIVITY

School News Desk — a morning-announcements show with real production roles. Reading fluency practice that students voluntarily rehearse, because the camera is rolling.

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LESSON · GRADES 6-8

How-To Video Studio

LEARNING OUTCOMES

- Students will plan shot variety for instructional clarity
- Students will capture clean audio and stable footage
- Students will sequence steps so a stranger can follow them

MATERIALS

- PadCaster rig + tripod + external mic
- Skill list (real skills students can teach)
- Shot-list template: wide, medium, close-up, insert
- Editing access for assembly

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Watch one good and one bad tutorial video — list what separates them.
2. Teams pick a teachable skill and script the steps precisely.
3. Shot planning: every step needs the right framing — inserts for hands, wides for context.
4. Shoot with the PadCaster: stability and mic distance are graded.
5. Edit for clarity: tight cuts, on-screen step labels.
6. The real test: a volunteer follows the finished video cold. Did they succeed?

ACTIVITY

How-To Video Studio — tutorial videos judged by whether a stranger can actually follow them. The volunteer test is unforgiving and utterly fair.

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LESSON · GRADES 9-12

Mini-Documentary Production

LEARNING OUTCOMES

- Students will develop a documentary story through pre-production
- Students will conduct and film interviews with b-roll coverage
- Students will edit a coherent narrative from raw footage

MATERIALS

- PadCaster rig + tripod + mic
- Pre-production packet: treatment, interview list, b-roll shot list
- Release/consent forms for interviewees
- Editing suite (WeVideo)

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Pitch round: teams propose school/community stories with actual access to subjects.
2. Pre-production: written treatment, confirmed interviews, planned b-roll list.
3. Interview shoots: framing, mic placement, and letting silences breathe.
4. B-roll days: gather 3x more coverage than feels necessary — they'll learn why in the edit.
5. The edit: find the story the footage actually tells (it's rarely the planned one).
6. Festival screening with director Q&A; after each film.

ACTIVITY

Mini-Documentary Production — a full pipeline from treatment to festival screening. Discovering in the edit that the story changed is the most honest filmmaking lesson there is.